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Between 2004 and last year, 40 per cent of Pakistan's imports of major conventional weapons came from the US

41 per cent of all US arms transfers to Pakistan over the past five years took place last year alone



PAKISTAN HAS ACQUIRED MORE F-16S TO DETER THE INDIAN AIR FORCE

The Spoils of WAR

Since 9/11, Pakistan has siphoned off billions of dollars from US aid for the 'War on Terror' to strengthen its offensive capabilities against India instead of the Taliban

| By Sandeep Unnithan |

Taking off from its base near Karachi, Pakistan's P-3C Orion, a US-built four-engined long-range maritime patrol aircraft, can fly nearly 9,000 km in 10 hours, carrying an array of torpedoes, weapons and anti-ship missiles to any point in the Indian Ocean. The Pakistan Navy is acquiring eight of these aircraft from the US after 9/11 as part of its role as a 'Major non-NATO Ally' in the war on terror. These aircraft, bought with US aid of \$970 million (Rs 4,800 crore) are pretty much useless against the Taliban, which is now threatening its existence, unless

Baitullah Masood, head of the Pakistani Taliban, begins acquiring a navy. The targets, say Indian defence planners, undoubtedly are Indian Navy ships and submarines. The Obama administration is now debating the Kerry-Lugar Bill which as part of its Af-Pak strategy will triple US assistance to Pakistan—\$7.5 billion (Rs 37,070 crore) over the next five years, including \$1.5 billion (Rs 7,400 crore) in military aid. The bill has resurrected concerns that this could be diverted for use against India. "Our experience has shown that military aid has been used against us in the past," Prime Minister Manmohan Singh said in New Delhi recently.

According to official US sources, Pakistan has received approximately \$12.3 billion (Rs 60,700 crore) in aid since 2002, of which \$8.6 billion (Rs 42,460 crore) came as military assistance. Where were the funds for military assistance spent? A recent study released by the Stockholm Institute of Peace Research Initiatives (SIPRI), an independent organisation which studies arms transfers, notes the deliveries in 2008—M-109A5 155-mm self-propelled artillery systems, P-3CUP Orion maritime patrol aircraft and F-16A combat aircraft. Needless to say, none of these will be used in the Pakistan military's ongoing offensive to evict the Taliban